INDIA · 2026

Five brands. Five ways in.

How global brands entered India this year, mapped to the entry-mode slides from my Global Marketing course at XLRI.

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THE FRAMEWORK

Every entry mode trades control for risk.



Low → high: **money committed, risk taken, control of the customer experience**

Global Marketing, XLRI: market entry and expansion

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RUNG 1 · LICENSING

Off-White



- Partner: Brand Concepts
- First store: Bengaluru, April 2026
- Five flagships planned in three years

> **Class lens:** test the market cheaply. Someone else runs your shop floor.

Source: FashionNetwork, Retail4Growth

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RUNG 2 · FRANCHISE

Lululemon



- Partner: Tata CLiQ
- First store: DLF Promenade, Delhi
- Online on Tata CLiQ Luxury and Fashion

> **Class lens:** a proven concept, run by a partner. The catch is picking and training that partner.

Source: afaqs, The Retail Bulletin

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RUNG 3 · PARTNER RUNS IT

SKIMS



- Exclusive partner: Reliance Brands
- Announced August 2026
- Flagships in Delhi and Mumbai, plus online

> **Class lens:** you're borrowing the partner's local muscle, and that's the whole point.

Source: FashionUnited, Business Today

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RUNG 4 · OWN IT

UNIQLO



- Wholly owned Indian subsidiary
- Jaipur opens 13 November
- Its 22nd store in India

> **Class lens:** you control everything. You pay for everything.

Source: Indian Retailer, Quartz

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RUNG 4 · OWN IT, ONLINE FIRST

IKEA



- Over $2.2 billion planned in India
- From 6 stores to about 30 by 2030
- Online before stores in new cities

> **Class lens:** e-commerce as an entry mode. Prove demand, then build.

Source: Reuters via Business Today, Domain-B

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THE OTHER SIDE

When the partner walks away.



- Jubilant won't renew Dunkin' after 31 December
- 27 outlets as of December 2025

> **Class lens:** in a franchise, your partner can end your market. It's that simple.

Source: Moneylife, Storyboard18

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MY READ

The entry mode is a brand decision.

If the product is the brand, a partner can sell it.

If the store is the brand, run it yourself.

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SAVE THIS

India 2026, by entry mode

Licensing	**Off-White**
Franchise	**Lululemon**
Partner runs it	**SKIMS**
Own it	**UNIQLO**
Own it, online first	**IKEA**
Partner exit	**Dunkin'**

> **The rule:** more control costs more, and it's worth it when the experience is the brand.

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Which entry mode would you pick for a global brand you love?

Name it in the comments.

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